

Guatemala

Ratio: 5:8 **Adopted:** August 17, 1871 **Usage:** National and State

Blue and white are the colors of the original flag of the United Provinces of Central America



The coat of arms was adopted in 1968

North America



Guatemala declared independence at the same time as Mexico and, in 1823, became part of a union with the other Central American states.

In Guatemala the flag of the United Provinces of Central America, horizontal stripes of blue, white, blue was used until 1851, when a pro-Spanish government added the red and yellow of Spain to the flag. On August 17, 1871, the original colors were restored as vertical stripes, and with Guatemala's own coat of arms.

THE QUETZAL BIRD

The new coat of arms shows the quetzal, Guatemala's most famous bird, standing on a scroll giving the date of the Declaration of Independence. The present form of the arms was adopted in 1968. When used at sea for civil purposes, the flag does not contain the arms.

ARMS OF GUATEMALA

